

CHAPTER FOURTEEN

# The Kissing Commandments

*Thou shalt not.*





I've spent this entire book telling you what to do. Techniques to master. Skills to develop. Approaches to embrace.

Now we need to talk about what not to do.

Because even perfect technique can be destroyed by a single egregious error. You can mirror beautifully, control the pace like James Bond, move your whole body like a dancer, and still ruin everything by committing one of the cardinal sins of kissing.

Consider this chapter your protective armor. Learn these commandments. Obey them. And you'll avoid the pitfalls that have derailed countless otherwise promising kisses.



### Commandment I: Thou Shalt Not Launch the Propeller Tongue

Remember when I mentioned propeller tongue back in Chapter 2? When I said it deserved its own commandment?

Here it is.

Propeller tongue is when someone sticks their tongue into their partner's mouth and immediately begins rotating it in circles. Around and around and around, like a helicopter blade, like a washing machine agitator, like something mechanical that got stuck in a loop.

I've seen this. I've felt this. I've coached people out of this habit that they didn't even know they had.

It's exhausting to receive. Your partner feels like they're being stirred rather than kissed. Their mouth becomes a passive container for your whirling appendage.

Here's the fix: tongue movement should be varied, responsive, and purposeful. It follows the Mirror Technique, responding to your partner. It explores, retreats, advances. It has rhythm but not repetition. It's a conversation, not a ceiling fan.

If you've ever done propeller tongue without realizing it, you're forgiven. But now you know. Stop.



## Commandment II: Thou Shalt Not Open the Whale Mouth

You know how in nature documentaries, whales open their massive mouths impossibly wide to swallow entire schools of fish?

Don't do that.

Whale mouth is when someone opens so wide during a kiss that they're essentially trying to consume their partner's entire lower face. It's aggressive, it's uncomfortable, and it creates a suction-cup effect that's more suffocating than sensual.

Your mouth should open just enough for comfortable tongue access. That's it. You're creating a connection, not performing a medical examination of their tonsils.

The test: can you still breathe through your nose comfortably? If your mouth is so wide open that you can't maintain nose breathing, you're in whale territory. Dial it back.



## Commandment III: Thou Shalt Not Be the Slobber Monster

Some moisture is inevitable in kissing. That's fine. That's normal.

But there's a difference between naturally occurring moisture and actively drooling into someone's mouth like a malfunctioning fountain.

I've had partners pull away from kisses needing to subtly wipe their entire face. That's too much. If your partner's chin looks like they just emerged from a swimming pool, something has gone wrong.

Control your saliva production. Swallow periodically (yes, during the kiss: it's not weird). Keep things moist, not flooded.

And here's a pro tip: if you know you tend toward excessive saliva production (some people just do), be mindful of how long you go between swallows. A quick, subtle swallow during a breath break keeps things manageable.



#### Commandment IV: Thou Shalt Not Tense Like Stone

Some people kiss with their entire face rigid. Their lips are tight. Their jaw is clenched. Their tongue is stiff. Every muscle in their face seems to be fighting against the kiss rather than participating in it.

This creates an unpleasant sensation for the partner. Instead of soft, responsive tissue meeting soft, responsive tissue, they feel like they're kissing a mannequin.

Relax your face. Soften your lips. Let your jaw hang slightly loose. Your tongue should be supple, not a rigid probe.

A good test: before a kiss, consciously release tension from your jaw. Let your mouth hang open just slightly. Shake your head gently to loosen the neck muscles. Feel the difference? That's the state you want to maintain.



#### Commandment V: Thou Shalt Not Jackhammer

Jackhammering is when the tongue makes rapid, repetitive, jabbing motions. In, out, in, out, in, out. Fast. Mechanical. Relentless.



*Even perfect technique can be destroyed by a single egregious error.*



This is usually a nervous habit. Someone is uncertain what to do with their tongue, so they default to high-speed repetition. Movement for movement's sake.

It's aggressive. It triggers the gag reflex. It leaves no room for response or reciprocation.

Slow down. Way down. Tongue movement should have pauses. Moments of stillness. Varied rhythm. You're dancing, not drilling.



## Commandment VI: Thou Shalt Not Forget the Breath Situation

We covered breathing in Chapter 9, but it bears repeating as a commandment because getting it wrong is so common and so devastating.

Bad breath kills kisses.

I don't care how good your technique is. I don't care how much you've practiced. If your mouth smells like a forgotten dumpster, none of it matters.

This isn't about perfection. It's about basic maintenance.

Brush. Floss. Drink water. Don't eat garlic right before a date. Use mouthwash if you want, but don't rely on it to cover fundamental hygiene failures.

And if you're unsure about your breath in the moment? Quick trick: excuse yourself to the bathroom, cup your hands over your nose and mouth, breathe out, breathe in. If it's bad, you'll know. Address it before the kiss.



### **Commandment VII: Thou Shalt Not Attack Without Warning**

The surprise attack kiss sounds romantic in movies. In reality, it's often startling, uncomfortable, or worse.

Swooping in without any buildup, without any indication of what's coming, without giving your partner a moment to prepare: this isn't passionate. It's ambushing.

Use the escalation ladder from Chapter 13. Build to the kiss through progressive touch. Use the Magic Words from Chapter 12 to signal your intent. Give them a chance to participate in the decision.

The exception: in an established relationship where you've kissed many times, surprise kisses can be playful and welcome. But even then, read the room. Is your partner in the middle of something? Stressed? Distracted? The surprise should be pleasant, not invasive.



### **Commandment VIII: Thou Shalt Not Ignore the Feedback**

Your partner is constantly communicating during a kiss. Their body language. Their sounds. Their responsiveness.

Ignoring this feedback is one of the worst things you can do.

If they pull back, don't chase. If they seem uncomfortable, check in. If they go passive and unresponsive, something is wrong.

The Mirror Technique isn't just about rhythm matching; it's about attention. You're supposed to be reading them, adjusting to them, responding to them.

Kissers who ignore feedback are essentially masturbating with another person's face. They're using the other person to execute their own kissing script without any regard for whether it's landing.

Don't be that person. Pay attention. Respond. Make it a dialogue.



## Commandment IX: Thou Shalt Not Execute the Same Move Forever

Variety. Variety. Variety.

Even the best technique becomes monotonous if you do nothing but that technique for ten straight minutes.

Change the angle. Change the intensity. Change the speed. Incorporate pauses. Move to the neck, the ear, the forehead. Come back. Go somewhere new.

A kiss should feel like a journey, not a treadmill.

If you catch yourself doing the same motion over and over, stop. Do something different. Anything different. The change itself will re-engage your partner's attention.





## Commandment X: Thou Shalt Not Neglect the Rest of the Body

Your mouth is doing things. Great. But what are the rest of you doing?



*Stay present. Stay aware. Pay attention. Everything else follows.*



Hands hanging limply at your sides while your mouth works overtime is a missed opportunity. Your whole body should be engaged.

We covered this in Chapter 4 (Dance) and Chapter 6 (Hands). But as a commandment: don't forget about them just because you're focused on lip technique.

Touch. Move. Engage. The kiss is full-body; don't let it become face-only.



## The Whistling Booger PSA

I debated including this because it's not romantic to discuss. But it's too important to skip.

Check your nose before kissing.

Seriously. A quick private mirror check. Make sure there's nothing visible. Make sure there's no obstruction that's going to create whistling sounds as you breathe.

Because nothing kills a moment faster than a high-pitched wheeze emanating from your nostril during a passionate kiss. Or worse: a visible situation that your partner is now trying very hard not to look at.

This is basic maintenance. Quick check. Handle it. Move on.



### **Bonus Commandment: The Hair Pull Done Wrong**

I told you in Chapter 7 how to do hair pulling right: grip at the scalp, not the strands. Create tension, not sharp pain.

Here's the wrong way, in case you need explicit don'ts:

Don't grab a small section and yank. Don't pull individual strands. Don't tug in a direction that wrenches their neck uncomfortably. Don't surprise someone with intense hair pulling if you haven't established that they're into it.

Hair pulling should feel like a firm massage of the scalp with added guidance. It should not feel like you're trying to rip their hair out.

When in doubt, start gentle. Increase only if they respond positively. And if they wince or say "ow," stop immediately and adjust.



## The Summary

Ten commandments plus a bonus. Let's list them clean:

1. Don't propeller tongue.
2. Don't open whale mouth.
3. Don't be the slobber monster.
4. Don't kiss tense like stone.
5. Don't jackhammer with your tongue.
6. Don't have bad breath.
7. Don't attack without warning.
8. Don't ignore feedback.
9. Don't do the same thing forever.
10. Don't neglect the rest of your body.
11. (Bonus) Don't pull hair wrong.

These aren't complicated. They're mostly about not doing things rather than doing things. Which makes them relatively easy to follow.

Think of them as guardrails. Stay inside them, and your technique will have room to shine. Violate them, and all the skill in the world won't save you.



## One Last Thing

You might have noticed that most of these commandments are about self-awareness.

Propeller tongue happens when you're not aware of what you're doing. Whale mouth happens when you're not aware of how far you've opened. Ignoring feedback happens when you're not paying attention to your partner.

The underlying commandment beneath all the others is this: Stay present. Stay aware. Pay attention.

A mindful kisser almost never commits these sins. They're too tuned in to themselves and their partner to fall into mechanical, disconnected patterns.

Be present. Everything else follows.



You now have everything: technique, touch, words, passion, confidence, and a list of things to avoid.

We're almost done now. But before we close, I want to step back and look at the bigger picture. What does all this really mean? Why does kissing matter so much?

Let me tell you.

